

Heat Exposure (Heat Exhaustion and Heat Stroke) - Female (Adult)

Algorithm 1322 | Adult (18 years and older) | Gender at birth: Female

Definition

- UAT-only Qatar adult and pediatric assessment separating heatstroke or other severe heat illness from heat exhaustion; sweating does not exclude heatstroke.
- Adult patient.
- Female.

Initial assessment

1. [OPEN_TEXT] What is the person's age, exact location, activity, clothing or protective equipment, medical conditions, pregnancy status, medicines, and access to air conditioning or shade?
2. [DURATION] How long was the heat exposure, when did symptoms begin, and how long have active cooling measures been used?
3. [TEMPERATURE] What is the measured temperature, by which method? Do not delay emergency action to obtain a temperature.
4. [YES_NO] Is there confusion, unusual behavior, slurred speech, poor coordination, collapse, seizure, reduced consciousness, severe breathing difficulty, or inability to drink safely?
5. [OPEN_TEXT] Is the skin hot, dry or sweaty, and are there headache, dizziness, nausea, vomiting, cramps, heavy sweating, weakness, thirst, fast breathing, or a rapid pulse?
6. [YES_NO] For a baby or child, is there reduced feeding, fewer wet nappies or less urine, no tears, sunken eyes or fontanelle, unusual sleepiness, irritability, or reduced responsiveness?

Triage and redirect questions

1. Redirect → Cold Exposure (Hypothermia)

Is cold exposure, shivering, or suspected low body temperature the main concern rather than heat exposure?

Cold exposure belongs in the Cold Exposure (Hypothermia) pathway.

1. Disposition level 100

After heat exposure, is there confusion, altered behavior, slurred speech, poor coordination, seizure, collapse or reduced consciousness, very high temperature, hot skin whether dry or still sweating, severe breathing difficulty, inability to drink safely, or no clear improvement after 30 minutes of active cooling?

Heatstroke is a time-critical emergency defined clinically by central nervous system dysfunction after heat exposure; sweating may continue and must not be used to rule it out. NHS.UK and CDC guidance require immediate emergency help and rapid cooling. A measured temperature is supportive but emergency action must not wait for it.

1. Disposition level 70

With no heatstroke feature, is there vomiting, inability to maintain oral fluids, worsening symptoms, significant dehydration, persistent symptoms despite cooling, or increased vulnerability such as infancy, pregnancy, older age, chronic heart or kidney disease, or medicines that impair heat tolerance?

Heat exhaustion that worsens, prevents safe hydration, or does not improve promptly can progress to heatstroke. Babies, children, pregnant people, older adults, and people with relevant chronic illness or medicines require a lower threshold for age-appropriate clinical assessment.

1. Disposition level 15

Is the person fully alert, improving promptly in a cool place, able to drink without vomiting, and experiencing only mild heat-exhaustion symptoms such as heavy sweating, thirst, headache, dizziness, weakness, nausea, or cramps, with none of the emergency or urgent features above?

NHS.UK guidance describes early heat exhaustion as manageable at home with cooling measures and usually resolves within 30 minutes.

Advice

Qatar heatstroke emergency cooling

- Call Qatar emergency services on 999 and do not allow the person to drive. Move them to shade or air conditioning, remove excess outer clothing and equipment, wet the skin with cool water, apply cool wet cloths, and fan continuously while awaiting help. Follow 999 instructions about more intensive cooling. Do not give anything by mouth if confused, drowsy, seizing, vomiting repeatedly, or unable to swallow safely. If unconscious but breathing, use the recovery position; if not breathing normally, start CPR if trained. Do not give fever medicine such as paracetamol or ibuprofen to treat heatstroke. Call Qatar 999 now, follow the call-taker's ambulance and emergency-transport instructions, and do not self-drive. Do not delay emergency care.
- Call Back If: confusion or abnormal behavior; seizure; loss of consciousness; very high temperature; breathing difficulty; no improvement with cooling.

Urgent heat-exhaustion assessment

- Continue active cooling in shade or air conditioning and arrange prompt age-appropriate in-person assessment through an approved Qatar route. Give small frequent sips of cool water or an appropriate oral rehydration drink only when fully alert and swallowing normally. Do not use salt tablets or give an infant sports drinks. Call 999 if confusion, reduced consciousness, seizure, severe breathing difficulty, inability to drink, or failure to improve within 30 minutes develops.
- Call Back If: confusion develops; vomiting prevents drinking; reduced urine; symptoms worsen; not improving within 30 minutes.

Closely monitored cooling for mild heat exhaustion

- Move to shade or air conditioning, stop activity, remove excess clothing, cool the skin with cool water and fanning, and give small frequent sips of cool water or an age-appropriate oral rehydration drink while fully alert. A responsible adult should monitor a child continuously. Do not return to heat or strenuous activity that day. Call 999 for any altered behavior, collapse, seizure, severe breathing difficulty, or failure to improve within 30

minutes.

- Call Back If: not improving within 30 minutes; confusion or unusual behavior; vomiting or inability to drink; reduced responsiveness; reduced urine.

First aid

- Call Qatar emergency services on 999 and do not allow the person to drive. Move them to shade or air conditioning, remove excess outer clothing and equipment, wet the skin with cool water, apply cool wet cloths, and fan continuously while awaiting help. Follow 999 instructions about more intensive cooling. Do not give anything by mouth if confused, drowsy, seizing, vomiting repeatedly, or unable to swallow safely. If unconscious but breathing, use the recovery position; if not breathing normally, start CPR if trained. Do not give fever medicine such as paracetamol or ibuprofen to treat heatstroke. Call Qatar 999 now, follow the call-taker's ambulance and emergency-transport instructions, and do not self-drive. Do not delay emergency care.

References

- Qatar Ministry of Public Health, "Healthcare Services in Qatar", <https://sportandhealth.moph.gov.qa/EN/faninfo/Pages/HealthcareServicesInQatar.aspx> (accessed 2026-07-25)
- NHS.UK, "Heat exhaustion and heatstroke", <https://www.nhs.uk/conditions/heat-exhaustion-heatstroke/> (page last reviewed 28 May 2026)
- US CDC/NIOSH, "Heat-related illnesses", <https://www.cdc.gov/niosh/heat-stress/about/illnesses.html> (accessed 2026-07-25)

Provenance

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